Staff answers: accurate history

Tuesday 12 January 2027 | P2 | 40 minutes | Year A

Humanities | LAUNCH | Spring 1 Week 2 | HUM-LAUNCH-S1-W02

Definition and lives

The Holocaust was the planned persecution and murder of six million European Jews by Nazi Germany, its allies and those who helped them. It took place from 1933 to 1945. The Nazis also persecuted and murdered millions of other people. Their experiences were not all the same.

The focus is Jewish lives, exclusion and human decisions. Do not reduce Jewish identity to victimhood or to a false racial category. Jewish people had varied religious and secular lives. S1 uses Anne's school and friends as one example, not a representative life for all Jews. Antisemitism predated 1933; do not present earlier Europe as free from prejudice.

Rights: date, place and nuance

S2: 7 April 1933, Germany. The civil-service law began excluding Jews from state employment. There were initial exemptions; do not say every Jewish person lost every job that day. A reasonable effect is loss of income or status.

S3: 15 September 1935, Germany. The Nuremberg Laws introduced citizenship restrictions; implementing rules in November defined who was targeted and stripped Jews of political rights. The pupil card therefore says the laws and later rules. Nazi racial classifications were false ideology, not science.

S4: November 1938, Germany. Jews were excluded from public schools and universities. The card focuses on pupils: lost access to education and separation from classmates. Do not imply all learning or every Jewish school ceased.

The sequence is selected, not complete. It is not a straight, inevitable path or a single Europe-wide timetable. Nazi Germany invaded the Netherlands in May 1940; later restrictions there affected Anne. Do not apply the German 1933/1935/1938 dates to Amsterdam.

Teacher-written model

This illustrative model is attributed to no real person. It is not testimony.

S2 dates the state-job law to 7 April 1933 in Germany. It began removing Jewish people from state work, though early exceptions existed. Losing work could remove income. Officials who enforced the rule helped persecution happen. Jewish people were not to blame.

Staff answers: actions and assessment

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Roles with care

S5: perpetrators included people who planned or enforced persecution. A witness who did not help may be described as a bystander, but the label covers varied actions and can conceal involvement. Taking a job from which Jews were excluded could deepen a person's stake in persecution. Do not equate every witness with every perpetrator or presume motives.

S6: Miep Gies was one helper among several. She brought food and books to eight people hiding in Amsterdam during 1942–1944. The eight were arrested in August 1944; Anne died in 1945. This is enough context. No death details are needed. Rescue was uncommon, carried risks and did not guarantee survival. People who were targeted also acted to protect their lives.

Accept: enforcing a school ban → denied education; witnessing exclusion without help → a person was left without that support; bringing food → helped sustain people in hiding. Distinguish what evidence says from a plausible effect. Never ask what pupils would have done in those circumstances.

Hinge and follow-up

Which explains a change to rights? A: 1938 came after 1935. B: The school ban cut access to education and separated pupils from classmates. C: Every country used the same rules on the same date.

B. A orders dates but gives no effect. C is false: place and date matter. Check both learners privately. If either needs help, model S2 as date + change + effect, then use the parallel check before independent work.

Parallel check: What did the 1935 laws and later rules take away from German Jews? Answer: citizenship and political rights. Ask the learner to identify Germany and explain that law does not mean fairness.

Judge the common finish

Keep your own record: one fact about Jewish life before persecution; two dated changes to rights with source codes and an effect; one action or inaction for each of the three roles; and one thought on remembrance and care today.

A short table or exact directed pointing can meet the same core demand. Supported: frames and private reading. Independent: chosen evidence and effects. Aspire: a reasoned limit of labels or rescue. Do not reward length or guess independent reading from adult-read work.

Closing examples: remember the full lives of those harmed; check historical claims with a trusted source; report antisemitic abuse safely to a trusted adult; treat people with dignity. Do not equate an everyday disagreement with the Holocaust or promise that a single kind act prevents genocide.

Offer to the Communication portfolio. Record R only after the learner gives an idea, an adult audience replies with one NS (next step), and the learner responds in the same colour, on the same page or usual mode. Record E only after actual banking. Keep the response mode and help used. A partner answer does not establish both learners' understanding.

Staff care and research basis

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Before teaching, review the school’s chosen memorial-day resource with the designated lead. Use it as a staff reference and check it against these care rules. No extra footage, camp photographs, testimony, graphic imagery or unplanned live browsing is used in this lesson.

For distress, stop the demand, acknowledge it calmly and offer the agreed route without a public explanation or sanction. Do not probe or insist on a historical recap while the pupil is upset. Listen to disclosures and follow the school’s existing safeguarding arrangements; record only what is needed in the appropriate private system.

For an antisemitic remark, interrupt calmly and firmly. Name the harm without repeating a slur. Explain that hostility towards Jewish people is antisemitism and is unacceptable. Jewish people were not responsible for their persecution. Correct the falsehood with a brief fact; do not debate Holocaust denial or ask pupils to defend Jewish people’s rights.

For flippancy or laughter, stop and reset the expectation of respect. A nervous response is possible, but harm still needs addressing. Follow up privately, check those affected and use existing behaviour and safeguarding procedures for targeted, repeated or serious incidents. Avoid public shaming or speculative labels about the pupil.

Offer the neutral quiet task and a private check on readiness to return. The alternative is not evidence of the Holocaust outcome. Record the history work as deferred or not yet evidenced, with a later supported offer. There is no penalty for taking the agreed pause.

Supervision is arranged before teaching. Keep both learners supervised; pause the whole group if the sole adult cannot safely support separate spaces. Use Support_Cards page 2 for the neutral alternative.

Historical research

H1 United States Holocaust Memorial Museum: Jewish Life in Europe before the Holocaust. H2 Anne Frank House: Who was Anne Frank? H3 United States Holocaust Memorial Museum: Anti-Jewish Legislation in Prewar Germany. H4 United States Holocaust Memorial Museum: Introduction to the Holocaust. H5 United States Holocaust Memorial Museum: Bystanders. H6 Anne Frank House: Miep Gies. H7 United States Holocaust Memorial Museum: Guidelines for Teaching about the Holocaust. H8 United States Holocaust Memorial Museum: International Holocaust Remembrance Day.

Only factual paraphrases are supplied. No testimony, archive text, website address or source image is reproduced. The teaching date is 12 January 2027; the annual memorial day is 27 January.